

# Distribution Pole Management and Inspection Plan (Draft for PUCT Submission)

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*Sedgewater Energy Holdings | Asset Management and Engineering | 2026-09-18 | v0.9*

DRAFT 0.9 - for internal review, not for filing. This draft sets out Sedgewater Electric Delivery's initial distribution pole management and inspection plan for submission to the PUCT. It describes the pole population, the current inspection and remediation program, 2026 results and the options for the inspection cycle. Prepared by the Pole Program on September 18, 2026; approval by the Vice President, Asset Management and Engineering is pending legal review.

## Draft status

Victor Salgado prepares the plan; Kwame Asante approves it before legal review. The internal target for submission is December 15, 2026. Open items are marked in section 7.

## 1. Requirement

Utilities must file a distribution pole management and inspection plan and update it by May 1 each year with the poles inspected and remediated. Initial plans are due to the PUCT by January 1, 2027. The PUCT must also adopt pole structural-integrity standards requiring inspection, remediation and replacement on a Commission timeline, with records.

Sedgewater's storm hardening plan already covers pole testing schedules, feeder inspection schedules and damage prediction; this plan replaces the pole sections of that plan.

## 2. Pole population

Sedgewater Electric Delivery owns about 290,400 distribution poles; about 94% are wood. The feeder register totals below give customers, circuit miles and poles for the 436 in-service feeders.

| Measure | Value           |
|---------|-----------------|
| Measure | customers       |
| Unit    | delivery points |
| Total   | 684892          |
| Mean    | 1570.8532       |
| Records | 436             |

|                |                          |
|----------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Period</b>  | 2026-08-31 to 2026-08-31 |
| <b>Measure</b> | oh_miles                 |
| <b>Unit</b>    | miles                    |
| <b>Total</b>   | 8860.0                   |
| <b>Mean</b>    | 20.3211                  |
| <b>Records</b> | 436                      |
| <b>Period</b>  | 2026-08-31 to 2026-08-31 |
| <b>Measure</b> | ug_miles                 |
| <b>Unit</b>    | miles                    |
| <b>Total</b>   | 5400.0                   |
| <b>Mean</b>    | 12.3853                  |
| <b>Records</b> | 436                      |
| <b>Period</b>  | 2026-08-31 to 2026-08-31 |
| <b>Measure</b> | poles                    |
| <b>Unit</b>    | poles                    |
| <b>Total</b>   | 290400                   |
| <b>Mean</b>    | 666.055                  |
| <b>Records</b> | 436                      |
| <b>Period</b>  | 2026-08-31 to 2026-08-31 |

All in-service distribution feeders at August 31, 2026, with customers, circuit miles, poles, automation, resiliency scope, last cycle trim and 2025 worst-feeder flag. No routes, coordinates or device locations.

### 3. Current program

Poles are inspected on a ten-year cycle, about 29,000 poles a year, using sound-and-bore and resistance testing. Outcomes are pass; restorable (bracing or reinforcement); priority reject, replaced within 90 days; and standard reject, replaced within 12 months. The 2026 plan calls for 29,500 inspections, mainly in Bayou District plus hardening-scope feeders in Harbor and Prairie.

### 4. 2026 inspection results to August

19,650 poles were inspected from January to August: 18,392 passed (93.6%), 413 were restorable, 177 were priority rejects and 668 standard rejects (4.3% rejected). 83% of the poles inspected were installed before 1980.

By district: Harbor 2,785 inspected, 4.3% rejected; Crossroads 292, 6.8%; Bayou 14,056, 4.1%; Prairie 2,517, 5.2%.

|                |                          |
|----------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Measure</b> | <b>Value</b>             |
| <b>Measure</b> | poles_inspected          |
| <b>Unit</b>    | poles                    |
| <b>Total</b>   | 19650                    |
| <b>Mean</b>    | 13.3764                  |
| <b>Records</b> | 1469                     |
| <b>Period</b>  | 2026-01-01 to 2026-08-31 |

|                |                          |
|----------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Measure</b> | poles_pass               |
| <b>Unit</b>    | poles                    |
| <b>Total</b>   | 18392                    |
| <b>Mean</b>    | 12.5201                  |
| <b>Records</b> | 1469                     |
| <b>Period</b>  | 2026-01-01 to 2026-08-31 |
| <b>Measure</b> | poles_restorable         |
| <b>Unit</b>    | poles                    |
| <b>Total</b>   | 413                      |
| <b>Mean</b>    | 0.2811                   |
| <b>Records</b> | 1469                     |
| <b>Period</b>  | 2026-01-01 to 2026-08-31 |
| <b>Measure</b> | poles_reject_priority    |
| <b>Unit</b>    | poles                    |
| <b>Total</b>   | 177                      |
| <b>Mean</b>    | 0.1205                   |
| <b>Records</b> | 1469                     |
| <b>Period</b>  | 2026-01-01 to 2026-08-31 |
| <b>Measure</b> | poles_reject_standard    |
| <b>Unit</b>    | poles                    |
| <b>Total</b>   | 668                      |
| <b>Mean</b>    | 0.4547                   |
| <b>Records</b> | 1469                     |
| <b>Period</b>  | 2026-01-01 to 2026-08-31 |
| <b>Measure</b> | poles_pre_1980           |
| <b>Unit</b>    | poles                    |
| <b>Total</b>   | 16363                    |
| <b>Mean</b>    | 11.1389                  |
| <b>Records</b> | 1469                     |
| <b>Period</b>  | 2026-01-01 to 2026-08-31 |

Every pole inspection batch closed from January to August 2026. One batch is one feeder section inspected by one contractor in one month; counts only, no pole identifiers or locations.

## 5. Remediation and replacement

Under the resiliency plan, 3,020 poles had been replaced or braced by August 31, 2026 against a 2026 target of 4,200. The May 19-22 wind event broke 1,140 poles, which were replaced during restoration and are not counted in the resiliency figures.

## 6. Inspection cycle options

Option A keeps the ten-year cycle, about 29,000 inspections a year, at an estimated \$6.8 million to \$7.6 million a year for inspection and testing. Option B moves to an eight-year cycle, about 36,300 inspections a year.

[To be completed: Option B cost estimate and the replacement forecasts for both options.]

## 7. Open items

- Complete the eight-year cost estimate and replacement forecasts.
- Confirm the record-keeping approach once the PUCT adopts its pole standards.
- Legal review of the draft before approval.